



ECE U-1,2,3 - ENGLISH FOR COMPETITIVE EXAMINATIONS NOTES

English for competitive examinations (Meenakshi Sundararajan Engineering College)



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UNIT I

Orientation on different formats of competitive exams - Vocabulary – Verbal ability – Verbal reasoning - Exploring the world of words – Essential words – Meaning and their usage – Synonyms antonyms – Word substitution – Word analogy – Idioms and phrases – Commonly confused words – Spellings – Word expansion – New words in use.

UNIT II

Grammar – Sentence improvement – Sentence completion – Rearranging phrases into sentences – Error identification – Tenses – Prepositions – Adjectives – Adverbs – Subject-verb agreement – Voice – Reported speech – Articles – Clauses – Speech patterns.

UNIT III

Reading - Specific information and detail – Identifying main and supporting ideas – Speed reading techniques – Improving global reading skills – Linking ideas – Summarising – Understanding argument – Identifying opinion/attitude and making inferences - Critical reading.

UNIT IV

Writing – Pre-writing techniques – Mind map - Describing pictures and facts - Paragraph structure – organising points – Rhetoric writing – Improving an answer – Drafting, writing and developing an argument – Focus on cohesion – Using cohesive devices – Analytic writing – Structure and types of essay – Mind maps – Structure of drafts, letters, memos, emails – Statements of Purpose – Structure, Content and Style.

UNIT V

Listening and Speaking – Contextual listening – Listening to instructions – Listening for specific information – Identifying detail, main ideas – Following signpost words – Stress, rhythm and intonation - Speaking to respond and elicit ideas – Guided speaking – Opening phrases – Interactive 226 communication – Dysfluency - Sentence stress – Speaking on a topic – Giving opinions – Giving an oral presentation – Telling a story or a personal anecdote – Talking about oneself - Utterance – Speech acts- Brainstorming ideas – Group discussion

UNIT I

Competitive exams come in various formats depending on the subject, level, and purpose of the exam. Here's a brief orientation on some of the common formats:

1. Objective Type (Multiple Choice Questions - MCQs):

- **Structure:** Candidates are given a question and several answer options, usually four or five. The task is to select the correct one.
- **Purpose:** Tests knowledge, quick recall, and sometimes logical reasoning.
- **Examples:**
 - SAT, GRE, and UPSC Preliminary Exam (India).

2. Descriptive Type:

- **Structure:** Candidates are asked to write detailed answers to essay-type or short-answer questions. These often test a candidate's depth of understanding, analytical ability, and writing skills.
- **Purpose:** Assesses critical thinking, clarity of expression, and subject knowledge.
- **Examples:**
 - UPSC Mains, Civil Services Exam (India), University-level exams.

3. Practical/Skill-Based Exams:

- **Structure:** Candidates are required to demonstrate practical skills or perform tasks under supervision. These exams test hands-on proficiency in a specific area.
- **Purpose:** Assesses practical knowledge and expertise.
- **Examples:**
 - Engineering lab exams, Medical practical exams, and Software programming assessments.

4. Aptitude Tests:

- **Structure:** These exams are designed to assess logical reasoning, quantitative ability, verbal ability, and problem-solving skills. They typically consist of multiple-choice questions.
- **Purpose:** Measures general mental abilities, rather than specific subject knowledge.
- **Examples:**
 - CAT (India), GRE, GMAT, and other recruitment tests like those for banking or software roles.

5. Oral/Interview-Based:

- **Structure:** In this format, candidates are assessed based on their verbal communication, thought processes, and general awareness. They may answer questions or present arguments in a face-to-face interview.
- **Purpose:** Tests interpersonal skills, depth of knowledge, and decision-making ability.
- **Examples:**
 - Civil Services Mains Interview, MBA interviews, and Job recruitment processes.

6. Combination of Formats:

- **Structure:** Some exams combine multiple formats to assess various aspects of a candidate. For example, a test may include an objective paper followed by a descriptive paper or interview.
- **Purpose:** Ensures a well-rounded assessment of a candidate's abilities.
- **Examples:**
 - UPSC (India) exams, SSC exams, Banking exams (e.g., IBPS PO).

7. Online Assessments:

- **Structure:** Conducted digitally, these exams may include multiple choice, fill-in-the-blank, or short-answer questions. They may be timed and can include real-time feedback.
- **Purpose:** To assess proficiency, time management, and sometimes to prevent malpractice.
- **Examples:**
 - Online entrance exams, coding tests (for tech recruitment), and certification exams (e.g., AWS, Google).

8. Performance-Based Tests:

- **Structure:** These tests assess candidates on tasks they are required to complete in a given timeframe, such as solving case studies, completing projects, or making presentations.
- **Purpose:** Evaluates practical skills, time management, and problem-solving abilities.
- **Examples:**
 - Business case competitions, law moot courts, or creative arts exams.

Each exam format is tailored to test different attributes of candidates, from academic knowledge and practical skills to logical reasoning and communication abilities. The format depends largely on the discipline and the objectives of the exam.

Vocabulary refers to the collection of words and phrases known and used by a person. In competitive exams, the **verbal ability** section tests a candidate's understanding of the meaning of words, their synonyms, antonyms, and ability to use them in context. **Verbal reasoning** focuses on testing the ability to understand and logically reason with language-based information.

Key Aspects of Vocabulary and Verbal Ability:

- **Word Meanings:** Recognizing the definition and context of words.
- **Synonyms:** Words with similar meanings.
- **Antonyms:** Words with opposite meanings.
- **Contextual Usage:** Using the right word in the right context.
- **Analogies:** Identifying relationships between words.
- **Word Analogies:** Drawing parallels between words based on their meanings.

Exploring words means delving deeper into their meanings, origins (etymology), usage in sentences, and understanding their nuances. This exploration helps in enhancing language comprehension and expression.

- **Etymology:** The study of the origin of words and how their meanings have evolved over time.
- **Word Roots:** Many English words are derived from Latin, Greek, French, and other languages. Understanding common prefixes, suffixes, and roots can help guess the meaning of unfamiliar words.

Example:

- *Prefix "pre-"* means "before." Words like **preview** (to view beforehand) or **precaution** (a measure taken in advance to prevent harm) demonstrate this.
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Essential Words are frequently used words that are crucial for communication and are often tested in exams. These words may have multiple meanings based on context, and their correct usage is critical.

Examples of Essential Words:

1. **Alleviate**
 - **Meaning:** To make a situation or condition less severe.
 - **Usage:** The medicine helped **alleviate** her pain.
2. **Candid**
 - **Meaning:** Honest and straightforward.
 - **Usage:** His **candid** response impressed the interviewers.
3. **Exacerbate**
 - **Meaning:** To make a problem or situation worse.
 - **Usage:** Her harsh comments only **exacerbated** the tension in the room.
4. **Obsolete**
 - **Meaning:** No longer in use; outdated.
 - **Usage:** With the advent of smartphones, many technologies have become **obsolete**.
5. **Meticulous**
 - **Meaning:** Showing great attention to detail; very careful and precise.
 - **Usage:** The artist was **meticulous** in painting every fine detail of the portrait.
6. **Aberrant**
 - **Meaning:** Deviating from the normal or expected course; abnormal.
 - **Usage:** His **aberrant** behavior in the meeting raised concerns among his colleagues.
7. **Cacophony**
 - **Meaning:** A harsh, discordant mixture of sounds.
 - **Usage:** The street was filled with the **cacophony** of honking cars and shouting vendors.
8. **Defenestrate**
 - **Meaning:** To throw someone or something out of a window.
 - **Usage:** In a fit of rage, he tried to **defenestrate** the old computer.
9. **Enervate**
 - **Meaning:** To drain energy from; to weaken.
 - **Usage:** The hot sun seemed to **enervate** the entire team, leaving them too tired to continue.
10. **Frivolous**
 - **Meaning:** Not having any serious purpose or value; trivial.

- **Usage:** The judge dismissed the case, stating that the lawsuit was **frivolous** and lacked merit.

11. Impetuous

- **Meaning:** Acting or done quickly and without thought or care; impulsive.
- **Usage:** His **impetuous** decision to invest in the stock market without research led to heavy losses.

12. Jocular

- **Meaning:** Characterized by joking; humorous or playful.
- **Usage:** His **jocular** nature made him the life of the party, always making everyone laugh.

13. Keen

- **Meaning:** Having a sharp edge or point; highly developed; eager or enthusiastic.
- **Usage:** She has a **keen** eye for detail, spotting even the smallest mistakes in the design.

14. Lethargic

- **Meaning:** Affected by lethargy; sluggish and lacking energy.
- **Usage:** After the long flight, I felt **lethargic** and struggled to stay awake during the meeting.

15. Mendacious

- **Meaning:** Habitually lying or untruthful.
- **Usage:** The politician's **mendacious** statements were exposed by investigative journalists.

16. Nefarious

- **Meaning:** Wicked or criminal in nature.
- **Usage:** The **nefarious** plot to overthrow the government was foiled by the authorities.

17. Obfuscate

- **Meaning:** To deliberately make something unclear or difficult to understand.
- **Usage:** The lawyer tried to **obfuscate** the issue by using legal jargon that the jury couldn't comprehend.

18. Pernicious

- **Meaning:** Having a harmful effect, especially in a gradual or subtle way.
- **Usage:** The **pernicious** effects of smoking are often not immediately apparent but develop over time.

19. Quixotic

- **Meaning:** Extremely idealistic; unrealistic and impractical.
- **Usage:** His **quixotic** plans to change the world through a single speech were met with skepticism.

20. Resilient

- **Meaning:** Able to recover quickly from difficult conditions; tough.
- **Usage:** Despite facing multiple setbacks, her **resilient** spirit allowed her to keep going.

21. Sycophant

- **Meaning:** A person who acts obsequiously towards someone important in order to gain advantage.
- **Usage:** The **sycophant** constantly praised the CEO, hoping for a promotion.

22. Trepidation

- **Meaning:** A feeling of fear or anxiety about something that may happen.
- **Usage:** She waited in **trepidation** for the results of the job interview.

23. Ubiquitous

- **Meaning:** Present, appearing, or found everywhere.
- **Usage:** Smartphones have become **ubiquitous**, seen in nearly every hand on the street.

24. Vicarious

- **Meaning:** Experienced in the imagination through the feelings or actions of another person.
- **Usage:** He lived **vicariously** through his son's achievements, often talking about them with great pride.

25. Wistful

- **Meaning:** Longing or yearning for something, often with a sense of sadness.
 - **Usage:** She gazed out the window with a **wistful** look, missing her hometown.
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Synonyms and Antonyms

Understanding **synonyms** (words with similar meanings) and **antonyms** (words with opposite meanings) is crucial for verbal reasoning, as it helps in comprehending the nuances of language. The questions often involve identifying which word fits best in a sentence or replacing a word with its correct synonym or antonym.

Example Sentence with Synonyms:

- "Her **melancholy** expression reflected her deep sadness."
(Synonym options: **Sorrow, Grief, Despair**)
 - Correct Answer: **Sorrow**

Examples of Synonyms:

1. **Happy**
 - Synonyms: **Joyful, Content, Cheerful, Pleased**
 - **Usage:** She was **joyful** after receiving the good news.
2. **Brave**
 - Synonyms: **Courageous, Fearless, Valiant, Intrepid**
 - **Usage:** The **valiant** soldier faced danger without hesitation.
3. **Smart**
 - Synonyms: **Intelligent, Clever, Astute, Bright**
 - **Usage:** His **clever** solution to the problem impressed everyone.
4. **Angry**
 - Synonyms: **Furious, Irate, Enraged, Annoyed**
 - **Usage:** She was **irate** when she found out about the delay in her flight.
5. **Beautiful**
 - Synonyms: **Lovely, Attractive, Radiant, Gorgeous**
 - **Usage:** The sunset was so **gorgeous** that we all stopped to admire it.
6. **Big**
 - Synonyms: **Large, Huge, Enormous, Gigantic**
 - **Usage:** The **huge** elephant appeared from behind the trees.
7. **Fast**
 - Synonyms: **Quick, Rapid, Speedy, Swift**
 - **Usage:** He is a **swift** runner and usually finishes the race in the top three.
8. **Important**
 - Synonyms: **Crucial, Vital, Significant, Essential**
 - **Usage:** It is **crucial** to complete your assignments on time for the final grade..
9. **Intelligent**
 - Synonyms: **Smart, Clever, Bright, Knowledgeable**
 - **Usage:** His **bright** mind allows him to solve problems that others find difficult.
10. **Hard**
 - Synonyms: **Difficult, Challenging, Tough, Arduous**
 - **Usage:** Climbing Mount Everest is an **arduous** journey that requires immense endurance.
11. **Lazy**
 - Synonyms: **Indolent, Idle, Lethargic, Inactive**
 - **Usage:** He felt **lethargic** after staying up all night studying for his exams.
12. **Love**
 - Synonyms: **Adore, Cherish, Care for, Appreciate**

- **Usage:** She **adores** her dog and takes him on walks every day.

13. Quiet

- Synonyms: **Silent, Hushed, Mute, Subdued**
- **Usage:** The library was **silent**, and everyone was focused on their reading.

14. Strong

- Synonyms: **Powerful, Sturdy, Robust, Tough**
- **Usage:** He has a **sturdy** build and can lift heavy weights with ease.

15. Cold

- Synonyms: **Chilly, Freezing, Icy, Frigid**
- **Usage:** The **icy** wind made it difficult to stay outside for long.

16. Quick

- Synonyms: **Fast, Rapid, Swift, Speedy**
- **Usage:** She made a **rapid** recovery after the surgery.

17. Rich

- Synonyms: **Wealthy, Affluent, Prosperous, Opulent**
- **Usage:** He comes from a **wealthy** family and owns several businesses.

18. Small

- Synonyms: **Tiny, Minuscule, Petite, Compact**
- **Usage:** The **tiny** puppy fit into the palm of my hand.

19. Sad

- Synonyms: **Sorrowful, Melancholy, Downcast, Dismal**
- **Usage:** He felt **sorrowful** after hearing about the passing of his childhood friend.

20. Old

- Synonyms: **Aged, Ancient, Elderly, Venerable**
- **Usage:** The **ancient** ruins of the city have stood the test of time for centuries.

21. Easy

- Synonyms: **Simple, Effortless, Straightforward, Uncomplicated**
- **Usage:** The math problem was so **simple** that even a child could solve it.

Example Sentence with Antonyms:

- "The scientist's theory was widely accepted by the community, but one researcher found it to be utterly **unfounded**."
(Antonym options: **Valid, Sound, Logical**)

Correct Answer: **Valid**

Examples of Antonyms:

1. Hot

- Antonyms: **Cold, Chilly, Freezing**
- **Usage:** The **cold** breeze was a relief after the scorching heat.

2. Generous

- Antonyms: **Stingy, Greedy, Selfish**
- **Usage:** He was known for being **stingy** and never shared with others.

3. Rich

- Antonyms: **Poor, Impoverished, Needy**
- **Usage:** The **poor** man lived in a small, modest house.

4. Easy

- Antonyms: **Difficult, Hard, Challenging**
- **Usage:** The exam was surprisingly **difficult**, and I couldn't finish all the questions.

5. Happy

- Antonyms: **Sad, Unhappy, Miserable**

- **Usage:** She felt **miserable** after hearing the disappointing news about her project.
- 6. Big**
 - **Antonyms:** Small, Tiny, Petite
 - **Usage:** The **tiny** puppy barely fit in the palm of my hand.
- 7. Light**
 - **Antonyms:** Heavy, Weighty, Burdensome
 - **Usage:** The backpack felt too **heavy** after walking for hours.
- 8. Sharp**
 - **Antonyms:** Dull, Blunt, Flat
 - **Usage:** The knife was so **blunt** that it couldn't even cut through the tomato.
- 9. Fast**
 - **Antonyms:** Slow, Sluggish, Languid
 - **Usage:** The car was moving so **slowly** that we thought it might break down.
- 10. Strong**
 - **Antonyms:** Weak, Fragile, Feeble
 - **Usage:** The **weak** bridge collapsed under the weight of the truck.
- 11. Early**
 - **Antonyms:** Late, Delayed, Tardy
 - **Usage:** He arrived **late** to the meeting, missing the important announcements.
- 12. Rich**
 - **Antonyms:** Poor, Needy, Impoverished
 - **Usage:** The **poor** family struggled to make ends meet in a tough economy.
- 13. Hard**
 - **Antonyms:** Soft, Gentle, Cushioned
 - **Usage:** The pillow was too **soft** and didn't provide enough support for my neck.
- 14. Warm**
 - **Antonyms:** Cold, Icy, Chilly
 - **Usage:** The **icy** winds made it impossible to go outside without a jacket.
- 15. Brave**
 - **Antonyms:** Cowardly, Timid, Fearful
 - **Usage:** His **cowardly** actions during the crisis led to his dismissal from the team.
- 16. Full**
 - **Antonyms:** Empty, Vacant, Hollow
 - **Usage:** The glass was **empty**, so I refilled it with water.
- 17. Clean**
 - **Antonyms:** Dirty, Messy, Filthy
 - **Usage:** His room was so **messy** that it took hours to tidy up.
- 18. Strong**
 - **Antonyms:** Fragile, Weak, Brittle
 - **Usage:** The **fragile** vase broke into pieces when it fell from the shelf.
- 19. Day**
 - **Antonyms:** Night, Darkness, Dusk
 - **Usage:** The city was much quieter at **night** compared to the hustle and bustle of the daytime.
- 20. Clean**
 - **Antonyms:** Dirty, Soiled, Polluted
 - **Usage:** The streets were so **dirty** that it was hard to find a clean spot to sit.
- 21. Near**
 - **Antonyms:** Far, Distant, Remote
 - **Usage:** The mountain peak seemed so **far** that it looked tiny on the horizon.

22. Quiet

- **Antonyms:** Loud, Noisy, Boisterous
- **Usage:** The party was so **loud** that I couldn't even hear myself think.

23. Old

- **Antonyms:** New, Modern, Fresh
- **Usage:** The **new** smartphone had many features that the old model lacked.

24. Light

- **Antonyms:** Dark, Dim, Gloomy
- **Usage:** The room was so **dark** that I had to turn on the flashlight to find my keys.

25. High

- **Antonyms:** Low, Short, Lowered
- **Usage:** The **low** temperature made it difficult to go out without bundling up.

26. Wide

- **Antonyms:** Narrow, Tight, Slim
- **Usage:** The **narrow** path through the forest was hard to navigate with a large backpack.

27. Gentle

- **Antonyms:** Harsh, Rough, Severe
- **Usage:** The **harsh** criticism from her boss left her feeling disheartened.

28. Young

- **Antonyms:** Old, Aged, Elderly
 - **Usage:** The **elderly** man needed help crossing the busy street.
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Common Vocabulary-based Questions in Exams

Fill-in-the-blanks: Where you need to select the correct word that fits the context.

1. The teacher's _____ approach to discipline made her popular among students.

(Options: a) strict, b) lenient, c) indifferent, d) hostile)

Correct Answer: b) Lenient

Explanation: "Lenient" suggests a more flexible or forgiving approach, which would be appreciated by students.

2. The company's new product was so _____ that customers immediately recognized its value.

(Options: a) obscure, b) innovative, c) outdated, d) mediocre)

Correct Answer: b) Innovative

Explanation: "Innovative" refers to something new and creative, which makes it valuable to customers.

3. Her _____ attitude towards the problem made it difficult for her to come up with a solution.

(Options: a) constructive, b) positive, c) apathetic, d) proactive)

Correct Answer: c) Apathetic

Explanation: "Apathetic" means lacking interest or emotion, which would prevent finding a solution.

4. The storm was _____ in nature, leaving no trace of destruction behind.

(Options: a) devastating, b) mild, c) violent, d) catastrophic)

Correct Answer: b) Mild

Explanation: "Mild" suggests a less intense or harmful storm, which would leave little damage.

5. His _____ response to the criticism showed his ability to remain calm under pressure.

(Options: a) volatile, b) composed, c) angry, d) evasive)

Correct Answer: b) Composed

Explanation: "Composed" means calm and in control, especially in difficult situations.

6. The research findings were _____, and they sparked a great deal of discussion among the scholars.

(Options: a) inconclusive, b) profound, c) irrelevant, d) trivial)

Correct Answer: b) Profound

Explanation: "Profound" refers to something deep or significant, which would generate discussion.

7. The CEO's _____ decision led to a significant increase in company profits.

(Options: a) impulsive, b) calculated, c) reckless, d) random)

Correct Answer: b) Calculated

Explanation: "Calculated" suggests a well-thought-out, strategic decision that led to success.

8. Her _____ behavior in the meeting made everyone feel uncomfortable.

(Options: a) polite, b) assertive, c) abrasive, d) courteous)

Correct Answer: c) Abrasive

Explanation: "Abrasive" describes behavior that is rude or overly harsh, causing discomfort.

9. The team's _____ efforts to complete the project ahead of schedule were praised by the management.

(Options: a) apathetic, b) diligent, c) careless, d) sporadic)

Correct Answer: b) Diligent

Explanation: "Diligent" refers to being hardworking and consistent, which would lead to a successful project completion.

10. The politician's _____ statements about the economy led to widespread public concern.

(Options: a) ambiguous, b) clear, c) optimistic, d) definitive)

Correct Answer: a) Ambiguous

Explanation: "Ambiguous" means unclear, which could cause confusion or concern.

11. The team's _____ strategy ensured that they achieved their goal within the deadline.

(Options: a) random, b) hasty, c) efficient, d) reckless)

Correct Answer: c) Efficient

Explanation: "Efficient" refers to a well-organized and effective approach to achieving goals.

12. Despite his _____ efforts, the project was delayed due to unforeseen circumstances.

(Options: a) half-hearted, b) persistent, c) negligent, d) casual)

Correct Answer: b) Persistent

Explanation: "Persistent" means continuing despite difficulties, which indicates consistent effort.

13. The author's _____ description of the city brought it to life for the readers.

(Options: a) vague, b) vivid, c) monotonous, d) dull)

Correct Answer: b) Vivid

Explanation: "Vivid" means detailed and colorful, creating a strong impression of the city.

14. The manager's _____ attitude towards employees made the work environment less stressful.

(Options: a) tyrannical, b) authoritarian, c) relaxed, d) demanding)

Correct Answer: c) Relaxed

Explanation: "Relaxed" means calm and easygoing, which would reduce stress in the workplace.

15. The company is seeking a _____ solution to improve employee productivity without increasing costs.

(Options: a) temporary, b) short-term, c) long-term, d) quick)

Correct Answer: c) Long-term

Explanation: "Long-term" suggests a sustainable and enduring solution that will have lasting effects.

16. The _____ evidence against the defendant led to his quick conviction.

(Options: a) circumstantial, b) weak, c) conclusive, d) unreliable)

Correct Answer: c) Conclusive

Explanation: "Conclusive" means definitive and final, making the evidence strong enough to secure a conviction.

17. The soldier's _____ courage on the battlefield inspired others to fight bravely.

(Options: a) feigned, b) admirable, c) hesitant, d) cowardly)

Correct Answer: b) Admirable

Explanation: "Admirable" means deserving respect, especially for courage in difficult situations.

18. The manager's _____ attitude towards work helped the team stay focused on the project.

(Options: a) indifferent, b) passionate, c) distracted, d) lazy)

Correct Answer: b) Passionate

Explanation: "Passionate" means showing strong enthusiasm, which would keep the team focused and motivated.

19. The _____ weather conditions caused the event to be postponed.

(Options: a) favorable, b) clear, c) inclement, d) moderate)

Correct Answer: c) Inclement

Explanation: "Inclement" refers to harsh or severe weather conditions that could disrupt plans.

20. Despite the _____ nature of the job, she remained focused and achieved excellent results.

(Options: a) monotonous, b) thrilling, c) dynamic, d) exciting)

Correct Answer: a) Monotonous

Explanation: "Monotonous" refers to something repetitive and dull, which she overcame to stay focused.

Word Pairing: Pairing words with their closest synonym or antonym.

Example:

1. Pair the word "ardent" with its synonym.

(Options: a) passionate, b) lazy, c) apathetic, d) indifferent)

Correct Answer: a) Passionate

Explanation: "Ardent" means passionate or enthusiastic.

2. Pair the word "reluctant" with its synonym.

(Options: a) eager, b) hesitant, c) willing, d) enthusiastic)

Correct Answer: b) Hesitant

Explanation: "Reluctant" means unwilling or hesitant.

3. Pair the word "candid" with its synonym.

(Options: a) dishonest, b) blunt, c) reserved, d) secretive)

Correct Answer: b) Blunt

Explanation: "Candid" refers to being straightforward or blunt in speech.

4. Pair the word "gregarious" with its antonym.

(Options: a) sociable, b) introverted, c) friendly, d) outgoing)

Correct Answer: b) Introverted

Explanation: "Gregarious" means sociable, so its antonym would be "introverted," which means reserved or shy.

5. Pair the word "abundant" with its synonym.

(Options: a) scarce, b) plentiful, c) inadequate, d) meager)

Correct Answer: b) Plentiful

Explanation: "Abundant" means in large quantities, or plentiful.

6. Pair the word "miserly" with its antonym.

(Options: a) generous, b) stingy, c) thrifty, d) frugal)

Correct Answer: a) Generous

Explanation: "Miserly" means very stingy, so its opposite would be "generous."

7. Pair the word "vivid" with its synonym.

(Options: a) dull, b) blurry, c) lively, d) vague)

Correct Answer: c) Lively

Explanation: "Vivid" refers to something very clear, bright, or lively, like a vivid image or description.

8. Pair the word "conservative" with its antonym.

(Options: a) traditional, b) liberal, c) cautious, d) conventional)

Correct Answer: b) Liberal

Explanation: "Conservative" means traditional or cautious, so its opposite would be "liberal," meaning open to change or progressive.

9. Pair the word "benevolent" with its antonym.

(Options: a) charitable, b) cruel, c) kind, d) generous)

Correct Answer: b) Cruel

Explanation: "Benevolent" means kind or generous, and the opposite of that is "cruel."

10. Pair the word "meticulous" with its synonym.

(Options: a) careless, b) precise, c) reckless, d) hurried)

Correct Answer: b) Precise

Explanation: "Meticulous" refers to being very careful and precise in detail.

11. Pair the word "dormant" with its antonym.

(Options: a) inactive, b) alive, c) active, d) sluggish)

Correct Answer: c) Active

Explanation: "Dormant" means inactive or in a state of rest, so its opposite would be "active."

12. Pair the word "conspicuous" with its antonym.

(Options: a) obvious, b) hidden, c) noticeable, d) evident)

Correct Answer: b) Hidden

Explanation: "Conspicuous" means easily noticeable or obvious, so the opposite would be "hidden."

13. Pair the word "profound" with its synonym.

(Options: a) shallow, b) deep, c) superficial, d) trivial)

Correct Answer: b) Deep

Explanation: "Profound" means deep, thoughtful, or intense.

14. Pair the word "sparse" with its antonym.

(Options: a) abundant, b) rare, c) few, d) limited)

Correct Answer: a) Abundant

Explanation: "Sparse" means scattered or thinly spread, so the opposite would be "abundant," meaning plentiful.

15. Pair the word "exuberant" with its synonym.

(Options: a) sad, b) joyful, c) depressed, d) lethargic)

Correct Answer: b) Joyful

Explanation: "Exuberant" refers to being very happy, enthusiastic, or full of energy, which is similar to "joyful."

16. Pair the word "indifferent" with its antonym.

(Options: a) concerned, b) apathetic, c) unconcerned, d) neutral)

Correct Answer: a) Concerned

Explanation: "Indifferent" means unconcerned or uninterested, so its opposite would be "concerned."

17. Pair the word "lucid" with its synonym.

(Options: a) unclear, b) logical, c) confusing, d) vague)

Correct Answer: b) Logical

Explanation: "Lucid" means clear or easy to understand, which aligns with "logical."

18. Pair the word "fragile" with its antonym.

(Options: a) delicate, b) sturdy, c) weak, d) brittle)

Correct Answer: b) Sturdy

Explanation: "Fragile" means delicate or easily broken, and its opposite is "sturdy," meaning strong and durable.

19. Pair the word "genuine" with its antonym.

(Options: a) authentic, b) fake, c) true, d) real)

Correct Answer: b) Fake

Explanation: "Genuine" means real or authentic, so the opposite would be "fake."

20. Pair the word "optimistic" with its antonym.

(Options: a) hopeful, b) pessimistic, c) positive, d) joyful)

Correct Answer: b) Pessimistic

Explanation: "Optimistic" refers to being hopeful about the future, and its opposite is "pessimistic," which refers to expecting the worst.

Odd one out: Identifying which word does not belong in a list based on meaning.

Example:

1. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Jubilant, b) Ecstatic, c) Happy, d) Depressed
 - **Correct Answer:** d) Depressed
 - *Explanation:* "Depressed" is an antonym of the other words, which all describe positive emotions.
-

2. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Eloquent, b) Fluent, c) Articulate, d) Silent
 - **Correct Answer:** d) Silent
 - *Explanation:* "Silent" is the opposite of the other words, which all describe ways of speaking effectively.
-

3. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Swift, b) Fast, c) Rapid, d) Sluggish
 - **Correct Answer:** d) **Sluggish**
 - *Explanation:* "Sluggish" is the opposite of the other words, which all describe speed or quickness.
-

4. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Courageous, b) Bold, c) Timid, d) Fearless
 - **Correct Answer:** c) **Timid**
 - *Explanation:* "Timid" is an antonym of the other words, which all describe bravery or boldness.
-

5. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Clumsy, b) Dexterous, c) Agile, d) Skillful
 - **Correct Answer:** a) **Clumsy**
 - *Explanation:* "Clumsy" refers to a lack of skill or coordination, whereas the other words describe skill and agility.
-

6. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Generous, b) Benevolent, c) Selfish, d) Charitable
 - **Correct Answer:** c) **Selfish**
 - *Explanation:* "Selfish" is an antonym of the other words, which describe kindness and giving.
-

7. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Expand, b) Increase, c) Enlarge, d) Shrink
 - **Correct Answer:** d) **Shrink**
 - *Explanation:* "Shrink" means to get smaller, whereas the other words mean to make something larger.
-

8. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Precise, b) Exact, c) Accurate, d) Vague
 - **Correct Answer:** d) **Vague**
 - *Explanation:* "Vague" means unclear or imprecise, whereas the other words describe something clear and exact.
-

9. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Melancholy, b) Sad, c) Joyful, d) Sorrowful
 - **Correct Answer:** c) **Joyful**
 - *Explanation:* "Joyful" is the opposite of the other words, which all describe sadness.
-

10. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Transparent, b) Clear, c) Opaque, d) Lucid
 - **Correct Answer:** c) **Opaque**
 - *Explanation:* "Opaque" means not transparent, whereas the other words describe something clear or easy to see through.
-

11. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Loud, b) Boisterous, c) Noisy, d) Quiet
 - **Correct Answer:** d) **Quiet**
 - *Explanation:* "Quiet" is the opposite of the other words, which describe loud sounds or behavior.
-

12. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Fragile, b) Breakable, c) Sturdy, d) Delicate
- **Correct Answer:** c) **Sturdy**
- *Explanation:* "Sturdy" is the opposite of the other words, which describe something that can easily break.

13. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Rich, b) Wealthy, c) Affluent, d) Poor
 - **Correct Answer:** d) **Poor**
 - *Explanation:* "Poor" is the opposite of the other words, which describe having wealth or abundance.
-

14. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Narrow, b) Tight, c) Wide, d) Broad
 - **Correct Answer:** c) **Wide**
 - *Explanation:* "Wide" is the opposite of "narrow" and "tight," which suggest a smaller or more restricted space.
-

15. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Aggressive, b) Hostile, c) Calm, d) Belligerent
 - **Correct Answer:** c) **Calm**
 - *Explanation:* "Calm" is the opposite of the other words, which describe aggressive or hostile behavior.
-

16. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Efficient, b) Effective, c) Wasteful, d) Productive
 - **Correct Answer:** c) **Wasteful**
 - *Explanation:* "Wasteful" is the opposite of the other words, which describe something that produces good results without wasting resources.
-

17. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Bright, b) Radiant, c) Dull, d) Shiny
 - **Correct Answer:** c) **Dull**
 - *Explanation:* "Dull" means lacking brightness, whereas the other words describe something that shines or is bright.
-

18. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Harmonious, b) Peaceful, c) Discordant, d) Calm
 - **Correct Answer:** c) **Discordant**
 - *Explanation:* "Discordant" means lacking harmony or being in conflict, which contrasts with the other words that describe peace or harmony.
-

19. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Generous, b) Benevolent, c) Miserly, d) Altruistic
 - **Correct Answer:** c) **Miserly**
 - *Explanation:* "Miserly" means very stingy, whereas the other words describe generosity or selflessness.
-

20. Identify the odd word out:

- **Options:** a) Quiet, b) Still, c) Peaceful, d) Noisy
 - **Correct Answer:** d) **Noisy**
 - *Explanation:* "Noisy" is the opposite of the other words, which describe quiet or calm conditions.
-

Word Analogy

A word analogy is a comparison between two pairs of words that have a similar relationship. It's often structured as "A is to B as C is to D." The goal is to identify the relationship between the words in the first pair and apply that relationship to find the correct word for the second pair.

Types of Word Analogies:

- **Synonyms:** Words that have the same or similar meanings.
 - Example:
 - **Big : Large** as **Small : Tiny**
 - Explanation: The relationship between "big" and "large" (synonyms) is the same as the relationship between "small" and "tiny."
 - **Antonyms:** Words with opposite meanings.
 - Example:
 - **Hot : Cold** as **Happy : Sad**
 - Explanation: The relationship between "hot" and "cold" (antonyms) is the same as the relationship between "happy" and "sad."
 - **Function:** The relationship based on the function or purpose of something.
 - Example:
 - **Pen : Write** as **Brush : Paint**
 - Explanation: A pen is used to write, and a brush is used to paint.
 - **Cause and Effect:** One word causes the other.
 - Example:
 - **Fire : Burn** as **Wind : Blow**
 - Explanation: Fire causes burning, and wind causes blowing.
 - **Part to Whole:** One word is a part of the other.
 - Example:
 - **Leaf : Tree** as **Petal : Flower**
 - Explanation: A leaf is part of a tree, and a petal is part of a flower.
-

Idioms and Phrases

An **idiom** is a group of words or a phrase where the meaning is not literal but figurative, and it cannot be understood just by knowing the individual meanings of the words.

Common Idioms and Their Meanings:

1. **Break the ice** – To initiate a conversation or start a social interaction.
 - Example: "He told a joke to break the ice at the meeting."
 2. **Burn the midnight oil** – To work late into the night.
 - Example: "She had to burn the midnight oil to finish her assignment."
 3. **A blessing in disguise** – Something that seems bad or unlucky at first but turns out to be good.
 - Example: "Losing that job was a blessing in disguise because it led me to a much better opportunity."
 4. **Hit the nail on the head** – To be exactly right about something.
 - Example: "When Jane said we needed more time, she hit the nail on the head."
 5. **Bite the bullet** – To face a difficult or unpleasant situation with courage.
 - Example: "I didn't want to take the test, but I had to bite the bullet and get it over with."
-

Commonly Confused Words

Many English learners and even native speakers often confuse words that sound similar or have similar meanings but are used in different contexts. Here are some examples:

Examples of Commonly Confused Words:

- **Affect vs. Effect**
 - **Affect** (verb) means to influence something.
Example: "The weather can affect your mood."

- **Effect** (noun) refers to the result of something.
Example: "The effect of the new policy was positive."
 - **Accept vs. Except**
 - **Accept** means to receive or agree to something.
Example: "I accept your invitation."
 - **Except** means to exclude.
Example: "Everyone except John was invited."
 - **Compliment vs. Complement**
 - **Compliment** means a praise or admiration.
Example: "She gave me a nice compliment on my outfit."
 - **Complement** means something that completes or enhances another thing.
Example: "The wine is a perfect complement to the cheese."
 - **Principle vs. Principal**
 - **Principle** refers to a fundamental truth or belief.
Example: "He believes in the principle of fairness."
 - **Principal** refers to the head of a school or the main person in a context.
Example: "The principal of the school gave a speech."
 - **Fewer vs. Less**
 - **Fewer** is used for countable nouns.
Example: "There are fewer apples in the basket."
 - **Less** is used for uncountable nouns.
Example: "There is less water in the bottle."
-

Spellings

Correct spelling is important, especially in competitive exams, where spelling errors can lead to loss of marks. Some common spelling issues include:

Tricky Spellings and Tips:

- **Accommodation**: Remember there are two 'c's and two 'm's.
- **Separate**: A common mistake is writing it as "seperate," but the correct spelling is "separate."
- **Embarrassment**: This word has two 'r's and two 's's.
- **Receive**: Follow the "i before e, except after c" rule.
- **Definitely**: Commonly misspelled as "definatly," but the correct spelling is "definitely."

Commonly Misspelled Words:

- **Occurrence** (not occurance)
 - **Acknowledge** (not acknowlege)
 - **Acquaintance** (not aquaintance)
 - **Necessary** (not necesary)
 - **Indispensable** (not indispensible)
-

Word Expansion

Word expansion refers to adding prefixes, suffixes, or even compound words to create new words. This is especially helpful in understanding how words can change in meaning or form.

Examples of Word Expansion:

- **Prefix**:

- **Un-**: unhappy, unkind, unclear
 - **Re-**: redo, rewrite, revisit
 - **Dis-**: disconnect, disagree, disapprove
 - **Suffix:**
 - **-ful**: beautiful, helpful, successful
 - **-ness**: happiness, kindness, darkness
 - **-ly**: quickly, happily, slowly
 - **Compound Words:**
 - **Mailbox** (mail + box)
 - **Basketball** (basket + ball)
 - **Sunlight** (sun + light)
-

New Words in Use

Language is constantly evolving, and new words are regularly added to the dictionary, often based on technological advancements, cultural changes, or new social trends. Here are some examples:

Examples of New Words:

1. **Selfie** – A photograph taken of oneself, often with a smartphone.
 - "She posted a selfie on social media."
2. **Vlog** – A video blog or video log, often posted on YouTube.
 - "He made a vlog about his travels around the world."
3. **Influencer** – A person who has the power to affect the purchasing decisions of others because of their authority, knowledge, or relationship with their audience.
 - "The fashion influencer partnered with the brand for a new campaign."
4. **Emoji** – A small digital image or icon used to express an idea, emotion, etc., in electronic communication.
 - "I sent her a smiley emoji in the message."
5. **FOMO** (Fear of Missing Out) – A feeling of anxiety that one might miss out on something exciting or interesting.
 - "I stayed at the party because I had FOMO about the fun they were having."
6. **Twerk** – A type of dance involving hip thrusts, typically associated with hip-hop or pop music.
 - "The dancers were twerking at the concert."

UNIT II

Grammar

Grammar is the system of rules that governs the structure of sentences in a language. It includes syntax (the arrangement of words) and morphology (the structure of words).

Key Areas of Grammar:

- **Parts of Speech:** These are the basic building blocks of grammar. Each part of speech plays a different role in a sentence.
 - **Noun:** Represents a person, place, thing, or idea (e.g., "book," "city," "love").
 - **Pronoun:** Replaces a noun (e.g., "he," "she," "it").
 - **Verb:** Indicates an action or state of being (e.g., "run," "is," "believe").
 - **Adjective:** Describes a noun (e.g., "beautiful," "tall").
 - **Adverb:** Modifies a verb, adjective, or other adverb (e.g., "quickly," "very").

- **Preposition:** Shows the relationship between a noun and another word (e.g., "in," "on," "under").
 - **Conjunction:** Connects words or groups of words (e.g., "and," "but," "because").
 - **Interjection:** A word or phrase that expresses emotion (e.g., "Wow!," "Oh no!").
-

Sentence Improvement

Sentence improvement involves modifying or correcting a sentence to make it grammatically correct, clearer, and more concise. This process can include correcting errors in punctuation, word choice, or sentence structure.

Common Errors to Fix:

- **Redundancy:** Using unnecessary words.
 - Example: "He returned back to the office."
 - Improved: "He returned to the office."
- **Wordiness:** Using more words than necessary.
 - Example: "In my opinion, I think that this book is excellent."
 - Improved: "I think this book is excellent."
- **Incorrect Verb Forms:**
 - Example: "She will going to the party."
 - Improved: "She will go to the party."
- **Ambiguity:** Making sentences clearer.
 - Example: "He saw the man with the telescope."
 - Improved: "He saw the man using the telescope."

Example Question:

- **Sentence:** "She was extremely tired but she didn't took rest."
 - **Improved Sentence:** "She was extremely tired but she didn't take rest."
 - **Sentence:** "He can sings very well."
 - **Improved Sentence:** "He can sing very well."
 - **Sentence:** "They was late for the meeting."
 - **Improved Sentence:** "They were late for the meeting."
 - **Sentence:** "She have never been to Paris."
 - **Improved Sentence:** "She has never been to Paris."
 - **Sentence:** "I don't know where is he going."
 - **Improved Sentence:** "I don't know where he is going."
 - **Sentence:** "He didn't knew the answer."
 - **Improved Sentence:** "He didn't know the answer."
 - **Sentence:** "She was so tired that she could hardly to keep her eyes open."
 - **Improved Sentence:** "She was so tired that she could hardly keep her eyes open."
 - **Sentence:** "The teacher told us we should study hard for the exam, but we didn't listened."
 - **Improved Sentence:** "The teacher told us we should study hard for the exam, but we didn't listen."
 - **Sentence:** "They was discussing about the project."
 - **Improved Sentence:** "They were discussing the project."
 - **Sentence:** "She can to play the piano very well."
 - **Improved Sentence:** "She can play the piano very well."
 - **Sentence:** "I have visited the museum yesterday."
 - **Improved Sentence:** "I visited the museum yesterday."
-

Sentence Completion

Sentence completion tasks test your ability to choose the correct word or phrase to complete an unfinished sentence based on the context provided.

Strategies for Sentence Completion:

- **Understand Context:** Pay attention to the tone of the sentence (positive, negative, neutral).
- **Grammar Check:** Ensure that the chosen word fits grammatically (verb tense, subject-verb agreement, etc.).
- **Look for Clues:** Often, previous words in the sentence will hint at the correct word choice.

Examples:

1. The new policy will _____ the efficiency of the process.
 - (a) increase
 - (b) decreased
 - (c) increases
 - (d) increasing

Correct Answer: (a) **increase**

Explanation: The sentence is referring to an increase in efficiency, so "increase" is the correct word. "Decreased" is incorrect, and the other two options are grammatically incorrect because they don't fit with the structure of the sentence.

2. Despite the rain, the event was a _____ success.
 - (a) total
 - (b) totalling
 - (c) totally
 - (d) totals

Correct Answer: (a) **total**

Explanation: "Total" is an adjective that fits grammatically, describing the noun "success."

Rearranging Phrases into Sentences

This task requires you to arrange words or phrases in a logical order to form a meaningful sentence.

Approach to Rearranging Sentences:

1. Identify the subject, verb, and object.
2. Rearrange words to create a grammatically correct and meaningful sentence.
3. Watch out for correct word order, especially for questions or negative sentences.

Examples:

1. **Given Phrases:** (is / book / this / interesting)
 - **Correct Sentence:** "Is this book interesting?"
 2. **Given Phrases:** (doing / she / well / is / in school)
 - **Correct Sentence:** "She is doing well in school."
 3. **Given Phrases:** (the answer / right / is / question / the)
 - **Correct Sentence:** "The answer is the right question."
-

Error Identification

Error identification tasks require you to find grammatical, syntactical, or contextual mistakes in a given sentence. Typically, these questions have multiple parts, and your task is to identify which part contains the error.

Common Types of Errors:

- **Subject-Verb Agreement:** The subject and verb must agree in number (singular/plural).
 - Incorrect: "She go to school every day."
 - Correct: "She goes to school every day."
- **Tense Errors:** Verb tense should be consistent throughout the sentence.
 - Incorrect: "He is reading a book and ate dinner."
 - Correct: "He is reading a book and eating dinner."
- **Preposition Errors:** Using incorrect prepositions in phrases.
 - Incorrect: "He is good in playing tennis."
 - Correct: "He is good at playing tennis."
- **Pronoun Errors:** Using incorrect or ambiguous pronouns.
 - Incorrect: "Each of the students must hand in their paper."
 - Correct: "Each of the students must hand in his or her paper."

Examples:

Sentence: "Neither of the boys have completed his homework."

- **Error:** "have" should be "has."
- **Correct Sentence:** "Neither of the boys has completed his homework."

Sentence: "She was looking forward to meet you."

- **Error:** "meet" should be "meeting."
- **Correct Sentence:** "She was looking forward to meeting you."

Sentence: "She did not liked the movie."

- **Error:** "liked" should be "like."
- **Correct Sentence:** "She did not like the movie."

Sentence: "Neither of the girls were at the party."

- **Error:** "were" should be "was" (Singular subject "Neither" requires a singular verb).
- **Correct Sentence:** "Neither of the girls was at the party."

Sentence: "The team have played well in the match."

- **Error:** "have" should be "has" (Collective noun "team" takes a singular verb).
- **Correct Sentence:** "The team has played well in the match."

Sentence: "Each of the players have a unique talent."

- **Error:** "have" should be "has" (The subject "each" is singular, so the verb should be singular).
- **Correct Sentence:** "Each of the players has a unique talent."

Sentence: "I was excited because he didn't attended the event."

- **Error:** "attended" should be "attend" (After "didn't," the verb should be in its base form).
- **Correct Sentence:** "I was excited because he didn't attend the event."

Sentence: "She don't like chocolate ice cream."

- **Error:** "don't" should be "doesn't" (The subject "She" requires the verb form "doesn't").
- **Correct Sentence:** "She doesn't like chocolate ice cream."

Sentence: "They was waiting for the bus when it started to rain."

- **Error:** "was" should be "were" (The subject "They" requires the verb form "were").
- **Correct Sentence:** "They were waiting for the bus when it started to rain."

Sentence: "If I would have known about the meeting, I would have attended."

- **Error:** "would have" should be "had" (Use the past perfect tense for hypothetical situations).

- **Correct Sentence:** "If I had known about the meeting, I would have attended."

Sentence: "The book on the table need to be read."

- **Error:** "need" should be "needs" (The subject "book" is singular, so the verb should be singular).
- **Correct Sentence:** "The book on the table needs to be read."

Sentence: "She can sings beautifully."

- **Error:** "sings" should be "sing" (After modal verbs like "can," the base form of the verb should be used).
- **Correct Sentence:** "She can sing beautifully."

Sentence: "He was the first person who arrived to the party."

- **Error:** "arrived to" should be "arrived at" (The correct preposition after "arrived" is "at" when referring to a place).
 - **Correct Sentence:** "He was the first person who arrived at the party."
-

Tenses

Tenses are used to express the time of an action or event in a sentence. There are three main tenses: **Past**, **Present**, and **Future**, each of which has four aspects: **Simple**, **Continuous (Progressive)**, **Perfect**, and **Perfect Continuous**.

Tenses Breakdown:

- **Present Tense:**
 - **Simple:** Describes general truths, habits, or routines.
 - Example: "She reads every morning."
 - **Continuous (Progressive):** Describes an action happening right now.
 - Example: "She is reading right now."
 - **Perfect:** Describes an action completed in the past but relevant in the present.
 - Example: "She has read the book."
 - **Perfect Continuous:** Describes an action that started in the past and is still ongoing.
 - Example: "She has been reading for an hour."
- **Past Tense:**
 - **Simple:** Describes an action that occurred at a specific time in the past.
 - Example: "She read the book yesterday."
 - **Continuous (Progressive):** Describes an action that was happening at a particular time in the past.
 - Example: "She was reading when I called her."
 - **Perfect:** Describes an action that was completed before another action in the past.
 - Example: "She had read the book before the meeting."
 - **Perfect Continuous:** Describes an ongoing action that was happening before a point in the past.
 - Example: "She had been reading for an hour when I arrived."
- **Future Tense:**
 - **Simple:** Describes an action that will happen in the future.
 - Example: "She will read the book tomorrow."
 - **Continuous (Progressive):** Describes an action that will be happening at a specific time in the future.
 - Example: "She will be reading at 7 PM."
 - **Perfect:** Describes an action that will be completed before a specified time in the future.
 - Example: "She will have read the book by tomorrow."
 - **Perfect Continuous:** Describes an ongoing action that will continue until a point in the future.
 - Example: "She will have been reading for an hour by the time I arrive."

Exercise: Tenses

Fill in the blanks with the correct tense form of the verb provided in parentheses.

1. By the time you arrive, I _____ (finish) my homework.
2. He _____ (play) football every Sunday.
3. Right now, she _____ (read) a book in the living room.
4. They _____ (not/complete) the project yet.
5. I _____ (study) when my friend called me.
6. We _____ (live) in this town for five years.
7. I _____ (never/see) such a beautiful sunset before.
8. By next month, they _____ (finish) the construction.
9. At this time tomorrow, we _____ (sit) on a beach in Hawaii.
10. She _____ (already/leave) when I arrived at the party.
11. When I was a child, I _____ (like) playing outside.
12. I _____ (look) forward to meeting you next week.
13. By the time you read this letter, I _____ (leave).
14. Right now, they _____ (watch) a movie.
15. I _____ (travel) to London next year.
16. They _____ (wait) for the bus when it started raining.
17. He _____ (speak) to the manager about the issue.
18. We _____ (work) on this report since this morning.
19. She _____ (arrive) at 9 AM tomorrow.
20. I _____ (not/decide) yet where to go for the holidays.

Answers:

1. By the time you arrive, I **will have finished** my homework.
(Future Perfect)
2. He **plays** football every Sunday.
(Present Simple)
3. Right now, she **is reading** a book in the living room.
(Present Continuous)
4. They **haven't completed** the project yet.
(Present Perfect)
5. I **was studying** when my friend called me.
(Past Continuous)
6. We **have lived** in this town for five years.
(Present Perfect)
7. I **have never seen** such a beautiful sunset before.
(Present Perfect)
8. By next month, they **will have finished** the construction.
(Future Perfect)
9. At this time tomorrow, we **will be sitting** on a beach in Hawaii.
(Future Continuous)
10. She **had already left** when I arrived at the party.
(Past Perfect)
11. When I was a child, I **liked** playing outside.
(Past Simple)
12. I **am looking** forward to meeting you next week.
(Present Continuous)

13. By the time you read this letter, I **will have left**.
(Future Perfect)
 14. Right now, they **are watching** a movie.
(Present Continuous)
 15. I **will be traveling** to London next year.
(Future Continuous)
 16. They **were waiting** for the bus when it started raining.
(Past Continuous)
 17. He **has spoken** to the manager about the issue.
(Present Perfect)
 18. We **have been working** on this report since this morning.
(Present Perfect Continuous)
 19. She **will arrive** at 9 AM tomorrow.
(Future Simple)
 20. I **have not decided** yet where to go for the holidays.
(Present Perfect)
-

Prepositions

Prepositions are words that show relationships between nouns (or pronouns) and other words in a sentence. They often indicate location, time, direction, and manner.

Common Prepositions:

- **Location:** in, on, at, under, above, between, near
 - Example: "The book is **on** the table."
- **Time:** at, in, on, before, after
 - Example: "I will meet you **at** 5 PM."
- **Direction:** to, from, towards
 - Example: "She walked **towards** the door."
- **Manner:** by, with, in
 - Example: "He solved the problem **with** a calculator."

Exercise 1: Fill in the blanks with the correct preposition.

1. The dog is sitting ____ the couch.
 2. We are going ____ a trip to the mountains next weekend.
 3. He looked ____ the window to see the rain.
 4. I'll wait for you ____ the bus stop.
 5. She is interested ____ learning new languages.
 6. The keys are ____ the table.
 7. We have been waiting ____ an hour.
 8. The cat jumped ____ the table and broke the vase.
 9. He works ____ a hospital.
 10. They are flying ____ New York tomorrow.
-

Exercise 2: Choose the correct preposition.

1. He arrived ____ the airport at 6 PM.
a) at
b) on
c) in
 2. I'm looking forward ____ meeting you next week.
a) to
b) at
c) for
 3. The children are playing ____ the playground.
a) in
b) on
c) at
 4. I live ____ the second floor of the building.
a) in
b) on
c) at
 5. She was born ____ 1995.
a) on
b) at
c) in
 6. I've been working ____ 9 AM.
a) for
b) since
c) by
 7. The coffee is ____ the table.
a) on
b) in
c) at
 8. The store is closed ____ Mondays.
a) on
b) in
c) at
 9. We stayed ____ a nice hotel during our trip.
a) at
b) on
c) in
 10. He was talking ____ his friend when I arrived.
a) to
b) with
c) at
-

Exercise 3: Correct the mistakes in these sentences.

1. I've been working here since five years.
2. She is sitting in the sofa.
3. He is married with a teacher.
4. We will meet on Friday at 3 PM.
5. The book is on the shelf between the two books.
6. She arrived at the airport on time.
7. The kids are playing at the garden.

8. We need to talk about the project in Monday.
 9. I'm good in tennis.
 10. She is always friendly with everyone.
-

Exercise 4: Fill in the correct preposition (at, in, on, for, since, to, by).

1. I've lived here ____ 2010.
 2. She'll arrive ____ 7 PM.
 3. I haven't seen Tom ____ ages.
 4. The meeting starts ____ 9 AM.
 5. He's been studying ____ two hours.
 6. The book is ____ the desk.
 7. The plane will land ____ the airport.
 8. She walked ____ the store to buy some milk.
 9. The train leaves ____ 10:30 AM.
 10. The kids are playing ____ the garden.
-

Answer Key:

Exercise 1:

1. on
2. for
3. out of
4. at
5. in
6. on
7. for
8. off
9. at
10. to

Exercise 2:

1. a) at
2. a) to
3. a) in
4. b) on
5. c) in
6. b) since
7. a) on
8. a) on
9. c) in
10. a) to

Exercise 3:

1. I've been working here **for** five years.
2. She is sitting **on** the sofa.
3. He is married **to** a teacher.
4. We will meet **on** Friday **at** 3 PM.
5. The book is **on** the shelf **between** the two books.

6. She arrived **at** the airport **on** time.
7. The kids are playing **in** the garden.
8. We need to talk about the project **on** Monday.
9. I'm good **at** tennis.
10. She is always friendly **to** everyone.

Exercise 4:

1. since
 2. at
 3. for
 4. at
 5. for
 6. on
 7. at
 8. to
 9. at
 10. in
-

Adjectives

Adjectives are words that describe or modify nouns (people, places, things, or ideas). They give more information about a noun.

Types of Adjectives:

- **Descriptive:** Describes the quality or characteristic of a noun.
 - Example: "She is wearing a **red** dress."
- **Quantitative:** Shows how much or how many.
 - Example: "He has **three** brothers."
- **Demonstrative:** Points out a specific noun.
 - Example: "I want **this** book."
- **Possessive:** Shows ownership.
 - Example: "This is **my** pen."
- **Interrogative:** Used in questions.
 - Example: "Which book do you want?"

Exercise 1: Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the adjective.

1. This book is ___ (interesting) than that one.
 2. The soup tastes ___ (delicious) than the one I had yesterday.
 3. She is the ___ (beautiful) girl in the class.
 4. I find math ___ (difficult) than English.
 5. The weather today is ___ (cold) than it was yesterday.
 6. He is the ___ (young) member of the team.
 7. This is the ___ (bad) movie I have ever seen.
 8. She is much ___ (kind) than her sister.
 9. The view from the top of the mountain is ___ (breathtaking) than I expected.
 10. My grandmother is ___ (old) than my grandfather.
-

Exercise 2: Choose the correct adjective.

1. The movie was really ____.
a) boring
b) bored
 2. The cake tastes ____.
a) sweet
b) sweeper
 3. She feels ____ today because she passed the exam.
a) happy
b) happily
 4. The homework is ____ than I thought.
a) easy
b) easier
 5. This test is ____ than the last one.
a) difficult
b) more difficult
 6. He is always ____ when it comes to helping others.
a) generous
b) generously
 7. The view from the window is ____.
a) amazing
b) amazed
 8. I had a ____ day at work today.
a) tiring
b) tired
 9. The teacher was ____ when explaining the new lesson.
a) patient
b) patiently
 10. The little boy looked ____ after his fall.
a) sad
b) sadly
-

Exercise 3: Correct the mistakes in these sentences.

1. She is more better at math than her brother.
 2. This test is the most easy of all the tests.
 3. He is the more tall player on the team.
 4. The food at the restaurant was more better than I expected.
 5. I think this painting is more beautiful than that one.
 6. My mom is the kindest person I know.
 7. This is the most happiest day of my life.
 8. The movie was very more exciting than the book.
 9. I feel very bad after hearing the news.
 10. The dog looks friendlier than the cat.
-

Exercise 4: Match the adjectives with their opposites.

1. happy	a) difficult
----------	--------------

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2. easy	b) cold
3. big	c) small
4. light	d) weak
5. clean	e) cheap
6. fast	f) quiet
7. hot	g) dirty
8. strong	h) slow
9. expensive	i) sad
10. loud	j) heavy

Answer Key:

Exercise 1:

1. more interesting
2. more delicious
3. most beautiful
4. more difficult
5. colder
6. youngest
7. worst
8. kinder
9. more breathtaking
10. older

Exercise 2:

1. a) boring
2. a) sweet
3. a) happy
4. b) easier
5. b) more difficult
6. a) generous
7. a) amazing
8. a) tiring
9. a) patient
10. a) sad

Exercise 3:

1. She is **better** at math than her brother.
2. This test is the **easiest** of all the tests.
3. He is the **tallest** player on the team.
4. The food at the restaurant was **better** than I expected.
5. I think this painting is **more beautiful** than that one.
6. My mom is the **person I know.**
7. This is the **happiest** day of my life.
8. The movie was **more exciting** than the book.
9. I feel very **bad** after hearing the news.
10. The dog looks **friendlier** than the cat.

Exercise 4:

1. i) sad
2. a) difficult

3. c) small
 4. j) heavy
 5. g) dirty
 6. h) slow
 7. b) cold
 8. d) weak
 9. e) cheap
 10. f) quiet
-

Adverbs

Adverbs modify verbs, adjectives, or other adverbs. They typically describe **how**, **when**, **where**, **how much**, or **to what extent**.

Types of Adverbs:

- **Manner:** Describes how something is done.
 - Example: "She sings **beautifully**."
- **Time:** Describes when something happens.
 - Example: "He will arrive **tomorrow**."
- **Place:** Describes where something happens.
 - Example: "She is sitting **here**."
- **Frequency:** Describes how often something happens.
 - Example: "He **always** arrives early."
- **Degree:** Describes the intensity of an action or quality.
 - Example: "The soup is **extremely** hot."

Exercise 1: Fill in the blanks with the correct adverb.

1. She sings ___ (beautiful).
 2. He worked ___ (hard) to finish the project on time.
 3. The students listened ___ (attentive) during the lecture.
 4. The weather is ___ (unusually) warm for this time of year.
 5. She answered the question ___ (confident).
 6. The team played ___ (well) during the match.
 7. He runs ___ (quick) than his brother.
 8. The children behaved ___ (bad) during the trip.
 9. They arrived ___ (early) for the meeting.
 10. She laughed ___ (loud) at the joke.
-

Exercise 2: Choose the correct adverb.

1. He arrived ___ to the party.
 - a) late
 - b) lately
2. She did her homework _____.
 - a) quick
 - b) quickly

3. The children are playing ___ in the garden.
a) happily
b) happy
 4. He talks ___ during meetings.
a) too much
b) too many
 5. The cat jumped ___ onto the table.
a) suddenly
b) sudden
 6. I will visit you _____.
a) soon
b) shortly
 7. She was crying ___ after the movie.
a) silently
b) silent
 8. He speaks English _____.
a) fluent
b) fluently
 9. They were driving ___ when I saw them.
a) fast
b) faster
 10. She finished the race _____.
a) barely
b) bare
-

Exercise 3: Correct the mistakes in these sentences.

1. She sings beautiful.
 2. He runs more fast than anyone.
 3. They always are late for class.
 4. I feel badly about the decision I made.
 5. The cake smells goodly.
 6. She speaks English very fluent.
 7. The children were behave badly yesterday.
 8. He plays the piano good.
 9. She answered the question very confident.
 10. We need to act quick if we want to finish on time.
-

Exercise 4: Identify the adverb in the sentence.

1. She smiled brightly after the compliment.
2. He quickly finished his homework before dinner.
3. The dog ran excitedly toward its owner.
4. They walked carefully across the icy road.
5. He speaks very clearly in front of the class.
6. The teacher explained the lesson slowly so everyone could understand.
7. She was dancing gracefully on stage.
8. He responded honestly to the question.
9. They waited patiently for their turn.

10. The child played quietly in the corner.

Answer Key:

Exercise 1:

1. beautifully
2. hard
3. attentively
4. unusually
5. confidently
6. well
7. quicker
8. badly
9. early
10. loudly

Exercise 2:

1. a) late
2. b) quickly
3. a) happily
4. a) too much
5. a) suddenly
6. a) soon
7. a) silently
8. b) fluently
9. a) fast
10. a) barely

Exercise 3:

1. She sings **beautifully**.
2. He runs **faster** than anyone.
3. They **are always** late for class.
4. I feel **bad** about the decision I made.
5. The cake smells **good**.
6. She speaks English very **fluently**.
7. The children were **behaving** badly yesterday.
8. He plays the piano **well**.
9. She answered the question very **confidently**.
10. We need to act **quickly** if we want to finish on time.

Exercise 4:

1. brightly
2. quickly
3. excitedly
4. carefully
5. clearly
6. slowly
7. gracefully
8. honestly
9. patiently

Subject-Verb Agreement

Subject-verb agreement refers to the rule that the subject and the verb in a sentence must agree in number (singular or plural).

Examples:

- **Singular Subject:** "The dog **barks** loudly."
- **Plural Subject:** "The dogs **bark** loudly."
- **Collective Noun:** "The team **is** playing well." (Although "team" refers to multiple people, it is treated as a singular entity.)

Common Errors:

- **Incorrect:** "The group of students **are** excited."
- **Correct:** "The group of students **is** excited."

Exercise 1: Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verb.

1. She ___ (go) to the gym every morning.
 2. The dogs ___ (bark) loudly at night.
 3. He ___ (be) very tired after the long journey.
 4. I ___ (have) a meeting at 10 AM tomorrow.
 5. They ___ (study) English at the language school.
 6. The teacher ___ (teach) math and science.
 7. My parents ___ (live) in a small house in the countryside.
 8. John and his friends ___ (play) basketball every Saturday.
 9. The children ___ (watch) a movie right now.
 10. It ___ (rain) a lot during the winter months.
-

Exercise 2: Choose the correct verb to complete each sentence.

1. The books on the shelf ___ (is/are) new.
 2. She ___ (have/has) a meeting with the CEO today.
 3. The news ___ (is/are) not good.
 4. The team ___ (was/were) very happy with the result.
 5. We ___ (does/do) not like to eat fast food.
 6. They ___ (has/have) just arrived at the airport.
 7. The company ___ (is/are) opening a new branch in Paris.
 8. The children ___ (was/were) playing in the park.
 9. He ___ (work/works) in a bank.
 10. The cat ___ (chase/chases) the mouse.
-

Exercise 3: Correct the mistakes in these sentences.

1. The team have practiced hard for the competition.

2. She don't like to swim in the ocean.
 3. The book are on the table.
 4. They was waiting for the bus when it started raining.
 5. My dog and my cat loves to play together.
 6. He have finished his homework already.
 7. The children enjoys playing in the playground.
 8. There is too many cars on the street.
 9. The teacher and the students was talking about the project.
 10. My parents doesn't like to travel during the winter.
-

Exercise 4: Choose the correct sentence.

1. a) The dog and the cat is outside.
b) The dog and the cat are outside.
 2. a) The teacher, along with the students, were late.
b) The teacher, along with the students, was late.
 3. a) Either the man or his wife are coming to the party.
b) Either the man or his wife is coming to the party.
 4. a) My brother and I goes to the gym every day.
b) My brother and I go to the gym every day.
 5. a) Each of the girls are going to the concert.
b) Each of the girls is going to the concert.
 6. a) Neither the manager nor the employees is here today.
b) Neither the manager nor the employees are here today.
 7. a) The news are very interesting today.
b) The news is very interesting today.
 8. a) She and her sister has a new car.
b) She and her sister have a new car.
 9. a) The cake smell delicious.
b) The cake smells delicious.
 10. a) There are a lot of people at the concert.
b) There is a lot of people at the concert.
-

Answer Key:

Exercise 1:

1. goes
2. bark
3. is
4. have
5. study
6. teaches
7. live
8. play
9. are watching
10. rains

Exercise 2:

1. are

2. has
3. is
4. was
5. do
6. have
7. is
8. were
9. works
10. chases

Exercise 3:

1. The team **has** practiced hard for the competition.
2. She **doesn't** like to swim in the ocean.
3. The book **is** on the table.
4. They **were** waiting for the bus when it started raining.
5. My dog and my cat **love** to play together.
6. He **has** finished his homework already.
7. The children **enjoy** playing in the playground.
8. There are too many cars on the street.
9. The teacher and the students **were** talking about the project.
10. My parents **don't** like to travel during the winter.

Exercise 4:

1. b) The dog and the cat **are** outside.
 2. b) The teacher, along with the students, **was** late.
 3. b) Either the man or his wife **is** coming to the party.
 4. b) My brother and I **go** to the gym every day.
 5. b) Each of the girls **is** going to the concert.
 6. a) Neither the manager nor the employees **are** here today.
 7. b) The news **is** very interesting today.
 8. b) She and her sister **have** a new car.
 9. b) The cake **smells** delicious.
 10. a) There **are** a lot of people at the concert.
-

Voice

Voice refers to the form of a verb that indicates whether the subject performs or receives the action. There are two voices: **Active** and **Passive**.

Active Voice:

- The subject performs the action.
 - Example: "The chef **cooked** the meal."

Passive Voice:

- The subject receives the action.
 - Example: "The meal **was cooked** by the chef."

Changing Active to Passive:

- Active: "She writes a letter."
- Passive: "A letter **is written** by her."

Examples Explained:

- **Active Voice:** The subject **performs** the action.
 - **Example:** "She plays the piano beautifully."
(She is doing the action of playing the piano.)
- **Passive Voice:** The subject **receives** the action.
 - **Example:** "The piano is played beautifully by her."
(The piano is the receiver of the action of being played.)

Exercise 1: Change the following sentences from active voice to passive voice.

1. The teacher explains the lesson every day.
 2. The chef cooked a delicious meal.
 3. They will finish the project next week.
 4. The company has launched a new product.
 5. She is writing a letter to her friend.
 6. People speak English all over the world.
 7. The children played football in the park.
 8. They are repairing the road.
 9. He gave her a beautiful gift.
 10. The manager will announce the decision tomorrow.
-

Exercise 2: Change the following sentences from passive voice to active voice.

1. The book was read by the student.
 2. The cake was baked by my mother.
 3. The movie is being watched by millions of people.
 4. The letter has been sent by the postman.
 5. A new law was passed by the government last year.
 6. The car was repaired by the mechanic.
 7. The work will be completed by the team by Friday.
 8. The house is being painted by the workers.
 9. The decision has been made by the committee.
 10. The emails are being checked by the assistant.
-

Exercise 3: Identify if the sentence is in active or passive voice.

1. The book was written by Mark Twain.
 2. She plays the piano beautifully.
 3. The car has been washed by John.
 4. I gave him the book yesterday.
 5. The film was directed by a famous director.
 6. They built the bridge last year.
 7. The house will be cleaned tomorrow.
 8. The letter was sent by mistake.
 9. The children are being taught by Mrs. Smith.
 10. He will finish the work soon.
-

Exercise 4: Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verb in active or passive voice.

1. The report _____ (submit) by the assistant last night.
 2. They _____ (not, finish) the work yet.
 3. A new restaurant _____ (open) in our neighborhood.
 4. The house _____ (paint) by the workers right now.
 5. He _____ (award) a prize for his excellent performance.
 6. The students _____ (study) English every day.
 7. The letter _____ (send) tomorrow.
 8. We _____ (invite) to the party last week.
 9. The new policies _____ (discuss) at the meeting tomorrow.
 10. The story _____ (tell) by the old man.
-

Answer Key:

Exercise 1: Active → Passive

1. The lesson is explained by the teacher every day.
 2. A delicious meal was cooked by the chef.
 3. The project will be finished next week.
 4. A new product has been launched by the company.
 5. A letter is being written by her to her friend.
 6. English is spoken all over the world.
 7. Football was played by the children in the park.
 8. The road is being repaired.
 9. A beautiful gift was given to her by him.
 10. The decision will be announced by the manager tomorrow.
-

Exercise 2: Passive → Active

1. The student read the book.
 2. My mother baked the cake.
 3. Millions of people are watching the movie.
 4. The postman has sent the letter.
 5. The government passed a new law last year.
 6. The mechanic repaired the car.
 7. The team will complete the work by Friday.
 8. The workers are painting the house.
 9. The committee has made the decision.
 10. The assistant is checking the emails.
-

Exercise 3: Identify Active or Passive

1. Passive
2. Active
3. Passive
4. Active

5. Passive
 6. Active
 7. Passive
 8. Passive
 9. Passive
 10. Active
-

Exercise 4: Complete the Sentences

1. was submitted
 2. haven't finished
 3. has opened
 4. is being painted
 5. was awarded
 6. study
 7. will be sent
 8. were invited
 9. will be discussed
 10. was told
-

Reported Speech

Reported speech (also called indirect speech) is used to report what someone has said without using their exact words (as in direct speech).

Direct Speech:

- Example: "She said, 'I am going to the store.'"

Reported Speech:

- Example: "She said that she was going to the store."

Changes in Reported Speech:

- **Tense Change:** Present simple becomes past simple, present continuous becomes past continuous, etc.
 - Example: "He says, 'I am studying.'" → "He said that he was studying." (Present Continuous → Past Continuous)
 - Example: "He said, 'I was studying.'" → "He said that he had been studying." (Past Continuous → Past Perfect Continuous)
- **Pronoun Changes:**
 - Example: "She said, 'I will help you.'" → "She said that she would help me."

Key Points for Reported Speech:

1. **Tenses change:** When converting from direct to reported speech, the tense often shifts back (e.g., present simple becomes past simple, present continuous becomes past continuous).
2. **Pronouns change:** The pronouns also change to reflect the speaker (e.g., "I" becomes "she/he").
3. **Reporting verbs:** Common reporting verbs include **said, told, asked, suggested, advised, explained**, etc.
4. **No quotation marks:** In reported speech, we don't use quotation marks.

Exercise 1: Change the following sentences into reported speech.

1. He said, "I am going to the store."
 2. She said, "I have completed the assignment."
 3. "I will visit you tomorrow," he said.
 4. They said, "We are watching a movie right now."
 5. "I don't like this book," she said.
 6. He said, "I can't find my keys."
 7. "We have been waiting for an hour," they said.
 8. "I was studying when you called me," she said.
 9. "Are you coming to the party?" she asked.
 10. "Please help me with my homework," he said.
-

Exercise 2: Choose the correct form of the verb in reported speech.

1. She said, "I will go to the bank tomorrow."
 - a) She said she will go to the bank tomorrow.
 - b) She said she would go to the bank tomorrow.
 - c) She said she is going to the bank tomorrow.
2. "I have never been to Paris," he said.
 - a) He said that he has never been to Paris.
 - b) He said that he had never been to Paris.
 - c) He said that he never been to Paris.
3. "It's raining outside," she said.
 - a) She said it is raining outside.
 - b) She said it was raining outside.
 - c) She said it was rained outside.
4. "I will help you with your homework," Tom said.
 - a) Tom said that he will help me with my homework.
 - b) Tom said that he would help me with my homework.
 - c) Tom said he is helping me with my homework.
5. "Can you call me later?" she asked.
 - a) She asked can I call her later.
 - b) She asked could I call her later.
 - c) She asked if I could call her later.
6. "I am tired," John said.
 - a) John said that he was tired.
 - b) John said that he is tired.
 - c) John said that he has been tired.
7. "Do you like coffee?" he asked.
 - a) He asked do I like coffee.
 - b) He asked if I like coffee.
 - c) He asked if I liked coffee.
8. "I am going to the gym now," she said.
 - a) She said that she is going to the gym now.
 - b) She said that she was going to the gym now.
 - c) She said that she was going to the gym then.
9. "We have finished our lunch," they said.
 - a) They said they have finished their lunch.
 - b) They said they had finished their lunch.
 - c) They said they finished their lunch.

10. "I don't understand this problem," he said.
 - a) He said that he didn't understand this problem.
 - b) He said that he does not understand this problem.
 - c) He said that he don't understand this problem.
-

Exercise 3: Correct the mistakes in these sentences.

1. She said that she will go to the party last night.
 2. He asked me if I can help him with the project.
 3. They said they are going to the beach next weekend.
 4. Tom said that he was seeing the movie tomorrow.
 5. She asked me if I had visited the museum last week.
 6. He said that he doesn't like playing football.
 7. "Why are you late?" the teacher asked.
 8. She said, "I have been reading this book for two hours."
 9. "Can you meet me at the airport?" he asked me.
 10. They asked us if we have seen the new movie.
-

Exercise 4: Report the following dialogue.

Original dialogue:

- Sarah: "I am feeling so tired today."
 - Alex: "You should take a rest. It will help you feel better."
 - Sarah: "Yes, I will rest for a while."
 - Alex: "You should drink some water too."
-

Answer Key:

Exercise 1:

1. He said that he was going to the store.
 2. She said that she had completed the assignment.
 3. He said that he would visit me tomorrow.
 4. They said that they were watching a movie right then.
 5. She said that she didn't like that book.
 6. He said that he couldn't find his keys.
 7. They said that they had been waiting for an hour.
 8. She said that she had been studying when I called her.
 9. She asked if I was coming to the party.
 10. He asked me to help him with his homework.
-

Exercise 2:

1. b) She said she would go to the bank tomorrow.
2. b) He said that he had never been to Paris.
3. b) She said it was raining outside.
4. b) Tom said that he would help me with my homework.

5. c) She asked if I could call her later.
 6. a) John said that he was tired.
 7. c) He asked if I liked coffee.
 8. c) She said that she was going to the gym then.
 9. b) They said they had finished their lunch.
 10. a) He said that he didn't understand this problem.
-

Exercise 3:

1. She said that she **had** gone to the party last night.
 2. He asked me if I **could** help him with the project.
 3. They said they **were** going to the beach next weekend.
 4. Tom said that he **was** seeing the movie tomorrow.
 5. She asked me if I **had** visited the museum last week.
 6. He said that he **didn't** like playing football.
 7. "Why **were** you late?" the teacher asked.
 8. She said, "I **had been** reading this book for two hours."
 9. "Can you meet me at the airport?" he **asked** me.
 10. They asked us if we **had** seen the new movie.
-

Exercise 4: Report the following dialogue.

Reported speech:

Sarah said that she was feeling so tired that day.

Alex told her that she should take a rest and that it would help her feel better.

Sarah said that she would rest for a while.

Alex also suggested that she should drink some water too.

Articles

Articles are words used to define a noun as specific or unspecific. There are two types: **Definite Article** and **Indefinite Articles**.

Definite Article:

- **The**: Refers to a specific item or group.
 - Example: "The dog is barking."

Indefinite Articles:

- **A**: Used before singular, countable nouns that are mentioned for the first time.
 - Example: "I saw **a** cat."
- **An**: Used before vowels (a, e, i, o, u) or silent h.
 - Example: "She is **an** honest person."

Key Points to Remember:

1. Use **"a"** before words that begin with a consonant sound (e.g., "a dog," "a university").
2. Use **"an"** before words that begin with a vowel sound (e.g., "an apple," "an hour").

3. Use **"the"** when referring to something specific or known to both the speaker and listener (e.g., "the moon," "the book on the table").
4. **Omit articles** with uncountable nouns and general references to things (e.g., "I need advice," "He went to school").

Exercise 1: Fill in the blanks with "a," "an," or "the."

1. She has ___ beautiful dress.
 2. I need ___ apple from the store.
 3. ___ book on the table is mine.
 4. I saw ___ dog in the park.
 5. We went to ___ restaurant last night.
 6. ___ moon looks beautiful tonight.
 7. I want to buy ___ car.
 8. She is ___ honest woman.
 9. ___ Earth revolves around ___ Sun.
 10. Can you pass me ___ pen on the table?
-

Exercise 2: Choose the correct article.

1. She wants to be ___ doctor when she grows up.
a) a
b) an
c) the
2. I've never seen ___ elephant before.
a) a
b) an
c) the
3. We are going to ___ beach tomorrow.
a) a
b) an
c) the
4. ___ Great Wall of China is a popular tourist destination.
a) a
b) an
c) the
5. He is ___ best student in the class.
a) a
b) an
c) the
6. She borrowed ___ pen from me.
a) a
b) an
c) the
7. I bought ___ orange from the market.
a) a
b) an
c) the
8. I'm reading ___ book that you gave me.
a) a

- b) an
 - c) the
 - 9. He is ___ European.
 - a) a
 - b) an
 - c) the
 - 10. I have ___ idea!
 - a) a
 - b) an
 - c) the
-

Exercise 3: Correct the mistakes in these sentences.

- 1. She is an unique artist.
 - 2. I have a book to read.
 - 3. I want to go to the Europe next summer.
 - 4. She is the honest person I know.
 - 5. I saw a movie yesterday. It was the interesting.
 - 6. He is a most talented musician.
 - 7. Can you give me an advice?
 - 8. He went to the university last year.
 - 9. We stayed at a hotel near the beach.
 - 10. I want to eat the apple from the fridge.
-

Exercise 4: Fill in the blanks with the correct article ("a," "an," or "the").

- 1. He is ___ teacher at ___ local school.
 - 2. I have ___ idea for ___ new project.
 - 3. She lives in ___ old house in ___ city center.
 - 4. I need to buy ___ umbrella.
 - 5. They are visiting ___ Great Wall of China next month.
 - 6. ___ Sun rises in ___ east.
 - 7. I saw ___ cat sitting on ___ wall.
 - 8. She gave me ___ advice I needed.
 - 9. We had ___ wonderful time at the party.
 - 10. It's ___ best movie I have ever seen.
-

Answer Key:

Exercise 1:

- 1. a
- 2. an
- 3. The
- 4. a
- 5. a
- 6. The
- 7. a
- 8. an

9. The, the
10. the

Exercise 2:

1. b) an
2. b) an
3. c) the
4. c) the
5. c) the
6. a) a
7. b) an
8. c) the
9. b) an
10. a) a

Exercise 3:

1. She is **a** unique artist. (Use "a" before "unique" because "unique" begins with a consonant sound, "y" sound.)
2. I have **a** book to read.
3. I want to go to **Europe** next summer. ("Europe" doesn't need "the" because it's a continent.)
4. She is **an** honest person I know. (Use "an" because "honest" starts with a vowel sound.)
5. I saw a movie yesterday. It was **interesting**. ("Interesting" is an adjective, not a noun.)
6. He is **the** most talented musician. (Use "the" because "most" refers to a superlative degree.)
7. Can you give me **some** advice? ("Advice" is uncountable, so no article is used.)
8. He went to **university** last year. (No article needed before "university" when referring to education generally.)
9. We stayed at **a** hotel near **the** beach.
10. I want to eat **the** apple from the fridge. (Use "the" because the apple is specific.)

Exercise 4:

1. He is **a** teacher at **a** local school.
 2. I have **an** idea for **a** new project.
 3. She lives in **an** old house in **the** city center.
 4. I need to buy **an** umbrella.
 5. They are visiting **the** Great Wall of China next month.
 6. **The** Sun rises in **the** east.
 7. I saw **a** cat sitting on **a** wall.
 8. She gave me **the** advice I needed.
 9. We had **a** wonderful time at the party.
 10. It's **the** best movie I have ever seen.
-

Clauses

A clause is a group of words that contains a subject and a verb. Clauses can be **independent** or **dependent**.

Types of Clauses:

- **Independent Clause:** Can stand alone as a complete sentence.
 - Example: "She went to the store."
- **Dependent Clause:** Cannot stand alone and must be connected to an independent clause.
 - Example: "Because she was tired, she went to bed early."

Explanation of Types of Clauses:

1. **Independent Clause:** A clause that can stand alone as a complete sentence (e.g., "She loves to read books.").
2. **Dependent Clause:** A clause that cannot stand alone and depends on an independent clause to form a complete sentence (e.g., "because she was tired").
3. **Relative Clauses:** Used to give more information about a noun, often beginning with words like *who*, *that*, *which* (e.g., "The book **that I borrowed** was great").
4. **Conditional Clauses:** Express a condition (often with "if" or "unless") (e.g., "If it rains, we will stay home").
5. **Adverbial Clauses:** Modify the verb and answer questions like when, why, where, or how (e.g., "We stayed inside **because it was raining**").
6. **Noun Clauses:** Act as a noun in the sentence, and can function as the subject, object, or complement (e.g., "I believe **that he is innocent**").

Exercise 1: Identify the independent and dependent clauses.

Read the sentences and identify which part is the **independent clause** and which part is the **dependent clause**.

1. I didn't go to the party because I was feeling sick.
 2. She loves to read books when she has free time.
 3. Although it was raining, we decided to go for a walk.
 4. If you study hard, you will pass the exam.
 5. He bought a new phone after he sold his old one.
 6. When I was young, I used to go fishing with my grandfather.
 7. They arrived late because the bus was delayed.
 8. I'll call you when I get home.
 9. Since it's cold outside, I'm staying indoors.
 10. She didn't come to the meeting although she had been invited.
-

Exercise 2: Combine the following sentences into one sentence using the appropriate conjunction (because, although, if, when, since).

1. He couldn't come to the meeting. He had to finish a project.
 2. The cake was delicious. We didn't have any left.
 3. I will go for a walk. It stops raining.
 4. The film was very interesting. The ending was confusing.
 5. She passed the test. She studied very hard.
-

Exercise 3: Identify the type of clause in each sentence. (Relative, Conditional, Adverbial, Noun)

1. The book that I borrowed was very interesting.
2. If you leave now, you will catch the bus.
3. She couldn't attend the meeting because she had a doctor's appointment.
4. I know that you are busy.
5. I will go to the store if I have time.
6. He didn't know where to find the document.
7. The man who is wearing a blue shirt is my uncle.

8. I can't go to the party because I have to study for the exam.
 9. She went home after she finished her work.
 10. I can't believe that he won the race.
-

Exercise 4: Correct the errors in the use of clauses in these sentences.

1. Although she was tired, but she continued working.
 2. I will go to the party if I will finish my work.
 3. He didn't want to go, so he stayed home although he had planned to go.
 4. She loves to dance, because it makes her feel happy.
 5. I don't know where is he going.
-

Answer Key:

Exercise 1: Identify Independent and Dependent Clauses

1. Independent: **I didn't go to the party**
Dependent: **because I was feeling sick**
 2. Independent: **She loves to read books**
Dependent: **when she has free time**
 3. Independent: **we decided to go for a walk**
Dependent: **Although it was raining**
 4. Independent: **you will pass the exam**
Dependent: **If you study hard**
 5. Independent: **He bought a new phone**
Dependent: **after he sold his old one**
 6. Independent: **I used to go fishing with my grandfather**
Dependent: **When I was young**
 7. Independent: **They arrived late**
Dependent: **because the bus was delayed**
 8. Independent: **I'll call you**
Dependent: **when I get home**
 9. Independent: **I'm staying indoors**
Dependent: **Since it's cold outside**
 10. Independent: **She didn't come to the meeting**
Dependent: **although she had been invited**
-

Exercise 2: Combine Sentences Using Conjunctions

1. He couldn't come to the meeting **because** he had to finish a project.
 2. The cake was delicious, **but** we didn't have any left.
 3. I will go for a walk **if** it stops raining.
 4. The film was very interesting, **although** the ending was confusing.
 5. She passed the test **because** she studied very hard.
-

Exercise 3: Identify the Type of Clause

1. **Relative Clause:** The book **that I borrowed** was very interesting.
 2. **Conditional Clause:** **If you leave now**, you will catch the bus.
 3. **Adverbial Clause:** She couldn't attend the meeting **because she had a doctor's appointment**.
 4. **Noun Clause:** I know **that you are busy**.
 5. **Conditional Clause:** I will go to the store **if I have time**.
 6. **Noun Clause:** He didn't know **where to find the document**.
 7. **Relative Clause:** The man **who is wearing a blue shirt** is my uncle.
 8. **Adverbial Clause:** I can't go to the party **because I have to study for the exam**.
 9. **Adverbial Clause:** She went home **after she finished her work**.
 10. **Noun Clause:** I can't believe **that he won the race**.
-

Exercise 4: Correct the Errors

1. **Corrected:** Although she was tired, **she** continued working.
 2. **Corrected:** I will go to the party **if I finish my work**.
 3. **Corrected:** He didn't want to go, so he stayed home **even though he had planned to go**.
 4. **Corrected:** She loves to dance, **because it makes her feel happy**.
 5. **Corrected:** I don't know **where he is going**.
-

Speech Patterns

Speech patterns refer to the typical way in which a speaker organizes and expresses their thoughts, which can vary depending on the type of communication, audience, and context.

Types of Speech Patterns:

- **Narrative:** Telling a story or describing events.
 - Example: "Once upon a time, there was a princess who lived in a castle."
- **Expository:** Explaining or informing.
 - Example: "The process of photosynthesis involves plants absorbing sunlight to produce food."
- **Persuasive:** Trying to convince the audience to agree with a point of view.
 - Example: "You should adopt a healthy lifestyle to improve your well-being."
- **Descriptive:** Giving detailed information about something.
 - Example: "The sun was setting, casting a warm, golden glow over the ocean."

UNIT III

When reading, it is important to identify **specific information** and **details** that contribute to the meaning of the text. These are the facts, examples, and explanations that help you understand the main ideas more clearly.

Key Concepts:

- **Specific Information:** This refers to clear and particular facts, figures, or descriptions in a text. It often answers "who," "what," "when," "where," and "how" questions.
 - **Examples:** "The meeting is scheduled for 3:00 PM," "The capital of France is Paris," "The book was published in 1999."
- **Details:** These are the pieces of information that support or elaborate on the main ideas or specific points made in the text.

- **Examples:** If a text mentions a country, details could include the population, languages spoken, and major industries.
- **Purpose of Identifying Specific Information and Detail:**
 - **Clarify Main Points:** Specific details help in fully understanding a central idea.
 - **Support Understanding:** Details back up arguments, explanations, or descriptions in a text.
 - **Improve Retention:** Helps readers recall key facts and remember important parts of the text.

Tips for Identifying Specific Information and Details:

- Look for **facts, figures, dates**, or names.
 - Pay attention to **descriptive language** (adjectives, specific nouns).
 - Underline or highlight key **examples** or **supporting statements**.
 - Focus on **who, what, where, when**, and **why** when answering questions about the text.
-

Identifying Main and Supporting Ideas

Identifying the **main idea** and **supporting details** is crucial for understanding the structure and message of a text.

Key Concepts:

- **Main Idea:** The central point or primary message that the author is conveying. It encapsulates the overall message of the text.
 - **Main Idea of a Paragraph:** The topic sentence usually contains the main idea. It sums up the main point that the rest of the paragraph will explain or support.
 - **Main Idea of the Text:** Often found in the introduction or conclusion, it is the overall theme or purpose of the entire piece.
- **Supporting Details:** These are the facts, examples, explanations, or descriptions that help to explain or prove the main idea.
 - **Examples of Supporting Details:** Statistics, quotes, definitions, anecdotes, explanations, or descriptions.

Tips for Identifying Main and Supporting Ideas:

1. **Look for the Topic Sentence:** In most paragraphs, the first or last sentence often presents the main idea.
2. **Summarize:** After reading a section, ask yourself, "What is the main point here?" Try to summarize the paragraph or section in one sentence.
3. **Identify Evidence or Examples:** Supporting details will clarify or give evidence for the main idea.
4. **Pay Attention to Transition Words:** Words like "for example," "because," "in addition," and "thus" often signal supporting details.
5. **In the Whole Text:** The main idea is generally found in the **introduction** or **thesis statement** and is developed throughout the text by the supporting details.

Examples:

- **Text:** "The importance of recycling cannot be overstated. Recycling helps reduce waste in landfills, saves energy, and conserves natural resources. For instance, recycling one aluminum can saves enough energy to power a TV for three hours."

- **Main Idea:** The importance of recycling.
 - **Supporting Details:** Recycling reduces waste, saves energy, and conserves resources. Example of saving energy with recycling aluminum.
-

Speed Reading Techniques

Speed reading is the practice of reading quickly without sacrificing comprehension. The goal is to increase your reading speed while retaining key information. Below are the most effective techniques for improving your reading speed.

1. Pre-Reading/Previewing

- **Purpose:** Pre-reading helps you understand the structure and main ideas of a text before diving into the details.
- **How to do it:**
 - **Skim the title, headings, subheadings, and any bolded or italicized text.**
 - **Read the first and last sentences of each paragraph** to get an overview.
 - **Look at any images, graphs, or captions**, which often summarize key information.

Benefit: Pre-reading gives you a mental framework of what to expect, allowing you to read faster and focus on important information.

2. Eliminate Subvocalization

- **What it is:** Subvocalization is the habit of silently pronouncing words in your head as you read them.
- **How to reduce it:**
 - Try to **avoid mouthing words or mentally pronouncing every word.**
 - Instead of focusing on individual words, **focus on groups of words** or entire phrases.
 - Use a **pointer or finger** to guide your eyes, encouraging them to move faster.

Benefit: Reducing subvocalization can increase reading speed by allowing you to process text without the mental delay caused by inner speech.

3. Improve Eye Movement

- **What it is:** Your eyes naturally make several stops (fixations) as they move across a line of text.
- **How to improve:**
 - **Minimize eye fixations:** Try to decrease the number of stops your eyes make per line. Practice making **larger eye jumps** between groups of words rather than reading word-by-word.
 - **Use Peripheral Vision:** Train your peripheral vision to capture words and phrases around your direct focus area.

Benefit: Faster eye movement means you can process more words in less time, speeding up reading.

4. Chunking (Reading in Chunks)

- **What it is:** Chunking is grouping words or phrases together to read them as a unit instead of reading each word individually.
- **How to do it:**
 - Start by reading **2-3 words at a time** instead of one.
 - Gradually **increase the size of the chunks** as you improve, so your eyes can take in and understand whole phrases in a single glance.

Benefit: This reduces the number of eye movements and speeds up comprehension.

5. Minimize Regression (Backtracking)

- **What it is:** Regression is when you go back and reread text you've already read, often out of habit or uncertainty.
- **How to reduce it:**
 - **Resist the urge to go back** and reread previous sentences or words.
 - Try to trust your initial understanding of the text; if necessary, use context to fill in any gaps.

Benefit: Minimizing regression helps you keep moving forward and maintains your reading speed.

6. Use a Pacer (Finger or Pointer)

- **What it is:** A pacer is a tool used to guide your eyes along the text, which can help reduce distractions and maintain focus.
- **How to use it:**
 - Use your **finger, pen, or a pointer** to move along the lines of text.
 - Try to keep your eyes in sync with the movement of the pacer, which helps prevent drifting and keeps you moving forward.

Benefit: A pacer helps focus your attention and prevents distractions, leading to faster reading.

7. Practice Reading Groups of Words

- **What it is:** Instead of reading word-by-word, focus on reading multiple words at once.
- **How to do it:**
 - Start by focusing on the center of a line and expanding your vision to take in 3-4 words or more at once.
 - Practice reading sentences or paragraphs in **groups** of related words, skipping over unnecessary small words like "the," "and," or "of."

Benefit: This reduces the number of eye movements per line and increases speed.

8. Increase Reading Speed Gradually

- **What it is:** Pushing yourself to read faster is crucial, but speed should increase **gradually**.
- **How to do it:**
 - Start by reading material you're familiar with or easy to understand, and try to read faster than your normal pace.

- **Challenge yourself** by setting a goal to read faster by 10-20% at a time.

Benefit: Gradual increase allows you to build your speed and comprehension at the same time.

9. Skimming and Scanning

- **What it is:** Skimming and scanning are techniques for quickly getting the gist of a text.
 - **Skimming:** Reading quickly to get a general sense of the content.
 - **Scanning:** Searching for specific information, like dates or names, within a text.
- **How to do it:**
 - For skimming, **move quickly** over paragraphs and focus on the first sentence of each one.
 - For scanning, look for key words or phrases and ignore the rest.

Benefit: These techniques allow you to gather essential information without reading every word.

10. Practice Regularly

- **What it is:** Speed reading is a skill that requires constant practice to master.
- **How to do it:**
 - Set aside time each day to practice speed reading techniques.
 - Use **online tools** or apps that help track reading speed and comprehension over time.

Benefit: Consistent practice will increase your speed and retention over time.

11. Optimize Your Reading Environment

- **What it is:** Your reading environment can impact your focus and speed.
- **How to improve it:**
 - Read in a **quiet space** free from distractions.
 - Ensure **good lighting** to reduce eye strain.

Benefit: A well-optimized environment helps maintain focus, reducing interruptions in the reading process.

Improving Global Reading Skills involves enhancing your ability to understand, analyze, and engage with texts more effectively. Key strategies include:

1. **Expanding Vocabulary:** Learn new words through context and practice to improve comprehension.
2. **Active Reading:** Engage with texts by previewing, summarizing, and questioning key points.
3. **Linking Ideas:** Connect concepts within the text to understand the broader message.
4. **Critical Thinking:** Evaluate the strength of arguments, identify bias, and assess evidence.
5. **Making Inferences:** Draw conclusions from implicit information and use background knowledge to deepen understanding.
6. **Regular Practice:** Read a variety of materials regularly to build fluency and comprehension.

Linking Ideas

Linking ideas refers to understanding how different pieces of information within a text are connected. Effective readers identify relationships such as cause-and-effect, comparison, contrast, and sequences. Pay attention to transition words (e.g., "therefore," "however," "for example") that signal these connections, helping to see the broader structure of the argument or narrative.

Summarizing

Summarizing involves condensing a text to its essential points. This means identifying the main ideas, key arguments, and critical details while leaving out extraneous information. A good summary is much shorter than the original text and in your own words.

Understanding Argument

Understanding an argument requires recognizing the author's main claim, the evidence used to support it, and how the argument is structured. Effective readers assess the strength of the argument by considering its logic, the quality of evidence, and the acknowledgment of counterarguments.

Identifying Opinion/Attitude

Identifying opinion or attitude means recognizing subjective views or feelings expressed by the author. This can be distinguished from factual information through words like "I believe," "it seems," or "in my opinion." Understanding the author's attitude (positive, negative, neutral) helps you assess the text's tone and bias.

Making Inferences

Making inferences is the ability to read between the lines and understand implied meanings not directly stated in the text. This involves drawing conclusions based on evidence and context. For example, you might infer a character's emotions or the cause of an event by looking at indirect clues.

Critical Reading

Critical reading is actively analyzing a text to assess its validity, logic, evidence, and implications. It involves questioning the author's assumptions, checking for bias, and evaluating the strength of the arguments presented. Critical readers also consider alternative viewpoints and think about the text's broader context.